and unique rule which is applied equally to Hindu, Muslim or Christian taluqadars.

This tendency to drift away from the old personal law will have to be stopped if the orthodox have their way. An attempt to do so is now being made by the Frontier Province Council where a ‘Moslem Personal law (Shariat) Application Bill’ was recently referred to a Select Committee for report. I have no idea what happened to this Bill afterwards. In the course of a debate in the Council on this Bill, a speaker ‘analysing the fundamental principles of Islam’ said that ‘if the Bill were passed they would have to see the law was carried out strictly in accordance with the Shariat’. He was opposed to the partial enforcement of the Shariat and wanted its full enforcement.

The demand that only a Muslim should administer the Shariat seems reasonable, for non-Moslims can hardly enter into its spirit. If the Moslims have their separate courts with their *qazi*s, there is no valid ground for refusing the same privilege to the Hindus or any other religious group. We shall thus have a number of courts of law functioning independently in each geographical area for each separate group. It will be something like the capitulation of semi-colonial countries but in a greatly exaggerated form, for the whole population will be divided up and not merely by some foreigners. Perhaps that will be a logical development of our communal separate electorates.

Each group of these separate courts will have its own laws and methods of procedure. Some difficulties will no doubt arise when the parties involved belong to different religious groups. Which court are they to go to and which law to follow? Perhaps mixed courts will grow up to deal with such cases and some kind of amalgam of laws and procedure be adopted by these courts. Criminal cases are likely to prove especially troublesome. If a Hindu steals a Muslim’s property, whose law is to be applied? Or in the case of adultery where the persons profess different religions. The choice between the two codes might have serious consequences for the punishments might vary greatly between them. I am not sure what punishment Manu has laid down for theft or adultery, but I have an idea (I